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THE PROSPECTOR

Mistakes Cost Miners Wins; ASU Triumphs 10-4, 6-4, 12-1

by Mac Balod

The WAC cellar door flung open even wider for the Miners over the weekend as the U.T. El Paso baseball team found the going rough with the number two nationally ranked Sun Devils of Arizona State University.

The Miners had several bright moments in the three-game series but couldn't come up with the winning runs. The local diamondsman dropped all three games.

The first game played Friday saw the Miners pull out to a 4-0 lead going into the fourth inning and it looked as if U.T. El Paso

would have its first conference win. This was shortlived, however, when miscues caught up with the Miners and the Sun Devils cashed in on the errors.

The final score was 10-4 and U.T. El Paso suffered its fourth consecutive loss to an Arizona school. (Two weeks ago the Miners were on the losing end of another three-game bout with the University of Arizona.)

Mike Beltran, a hard-throwing righthander, got the mound nod to start for the Miners in the first of two games Saturday and held the visitors scoreless until the top of the fourth frame.

The Sun Devils drew first blood and pushed across two runs before Coach Andy Cohen's charges stopped the threat. Beltran made two outstanding plays in the fourth inning by picking off two base runners.

Arizona State padded its two-run lead with two more in the sixth but the Miners stormed back and knotted the contest in the bottom of the inning.

The Miners got their initial run on a line drive single by Joe Pennies which brought in Joe Kuentler who earlier got a free ticket to first. Ernie Carreon, who

relieved Beltran early in the sixth inning, belted a bases-loaded triple to deep left field to score Terry Baker, Pennies and Barry Alburtis.

Both teams failed to score in the seventh and eighth innings. In the top of the ninth the U.T. El Paso defense weakened and it was the same story as in other Miner games — costly errors. Arizona took the lead to stay by pushing across two runs on a Miner error and an eventual 6-4 victory.

The third game was a nightmare for the Miners as Arizona walked off with an easy 12-1 win. Phil Darwin hurled for U.T. El Paso but was quickly pulled out when Sun Devil bats powered four runs in the first inning.

Arizona State scored three more in the second frame, added an additional two in the fourth and topped it with three more in the sixth inning. The Miners' lone tally came in the bottom of the sixth frame.

U.T. El Paso stands 0-6 in the Southern Division of the WAC conference and sports a dismal over-all 10-27 record. The Miners will face the University of New Mexico tomorrow and Saturday in another three-game encounter.

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